

...I told her this. Later that day she told me, "don't compare yourself to anyone else, nothing good comes from comparing." I've heard those words before, but this is the first time they hit my heart - because they came from hers.

Each person on earth is on an individual journey, whether we accept it or not. If you don't stay in touch with your true self, and if you don't allow yourself to be whoever you are - evolving from moment to moment - a time will come that you turn around and realise you left your self somewhere along the way. The further away they are, the harder it is to embrace them. Many turn back around and keep going without them. It is always possible to find them again. It takes honesty (with yourself, the hardest kind) and courage (from within, the hardest kind), but everyone has the power.



This is Kae. She volunteers at monasteries as a gardener, and blends in completely with the plants she so genuinely cares for. So much so that, even though she's volunteered at this monastery for 4 years, our teacher had no idea who she was when I asked about her.

She sometimes goes months without speaking, and she aims to find a way to move to a jungle monastery to meditate for 15-18 hours a day, to dedicate her life internally. This shocked me. When I spoke to her I had just spent a week learning that there is a whole universe to be discovered within us, a plane of existence we live with every day but barely notice. Still, I couldn't imagine disappearing from the physical world in such a way. Her energy was so beautiful and pure, I felt lucky to be speaking to her but heartbroken for the rest of the world that her energy would be locked away...



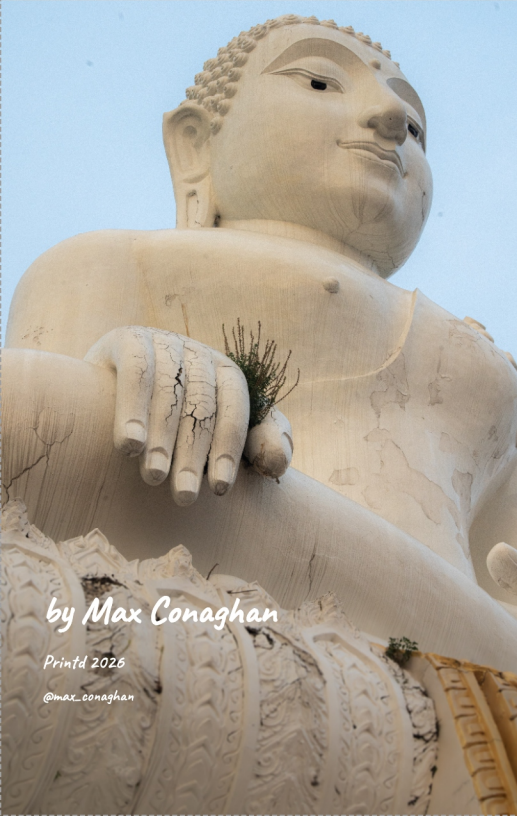
These plants are taken care of with complete mindfulness and love. You can see in this image that Kae is picking just the petals of the flowers, which she uses to create fertilizer for the next generation of flowers. This constant flow of energy is what makes the plants so healthy and full of life that they literally glow. It's the same practice she uses in herself through meditation.

Mindfulness is a meditative practice, in that once it becomes part of your life, meditation is in everything you do. Kae is a flower. Meditation is her picking petals in the form of thoughts, feelings and experiences, releasing her from their burden, and using the newly freed energy to fertilise future growth.

In always humbled to meet truly spiritual people. Their words and actions may seem ordinary or even random at first, but once you're learnt the lesson for yourself their words become reassuring wisdom.

True teaching is in holding space for someone to learn for themselves and, when necessary, gently reminding them what they're here to learn.

I never saw her face, but I recognise her spirit. I hope you do too.



by Max Conaghan

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